

MARK STRAYER
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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Economics, Purdue University	Expected 2029
M.A. Economics, Michigan State University	2025
–Completed first-year PhD core sequence in micro, macro, and econometrics	
Graduate Study, Master of Science in Statistics, American University	2016–2017
Master of Public Policy, University of Michigan	2010
–Paul A. Wright Scholarship	
B.A. Philosophy, Augustana College	2005
–Magna Cum Laude; Phi Beta Kappa	

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Labor Economics; Economics of Education; Public Economics

RESEARCH

Working Papers

“Doing More with Less? Right-to-Work Laws, School Productivity, and Student Achievement”

Abstract: In this paper, I investigate the relationship between Right-to-Work laws, K–12 student achievement, and school resource allocation. I am currently revising the analysis. An updated manuscript will be made available upon completion of the revision.

Policy Reports and Publications

- “Map the Meal Gap 2022: An Analysis of County and Congressional District Food Insecurity and County Food Cost in the United States in 2020,” Feeding America, July 2022. *Key contributor.*
- “The Army UCX Claimants’ Initiative: A Formative Case Study,” Mathematica, September 2016. *Coauthor.*
- “Preventing School Dropout: Findings Report, School Dropout Prevention Pilot Program,” Creative Associates, September 2015. *Coauthor.*
- “Providing Services to Veterans Through the Public Workforce System: Descriptive Findings from the WIA Gold Standard Evaluation,” Mathematica, March 2015. *Coauthor.*
- “Characteristics of Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program Households: Fiscal Year 2011,” USDA Food and Nutrition Service, November 2012. *Lead author.*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Feeding America, Chicago, IL, Senior Research Analyst 2018–2023

- Technical lead for Map the Meal Gap; replicated and extended CPS- and ACS-based small-area estimation models.
- Oversaw all data cleaning, estimation, and QC for county- and district-level food insecurity measures.
- Technical lead on the State of Senior Hunger project, producing national and state-level food insecurity estimates for older adults.

Mathematica Policy Research, Washington, DC, Senior Programmer Analyst 2016

Mathematica Policy Research, Washington, DC, Research Analyst III 2010–2015

- Designed and executed quantitative analyses for the Army UCX Claimants Initiative; programmed all Stata analysis.
- Led analyses of school dropout interventions across four East Asian countries; coauthored USAID reports.
- Conducted workforce program impact analyses for veteran services using administrative and survey data.
- Developed rapid-turnaround simulations for USDA on SNAP program reforms and distributional impacts.
- Reviewed research rigor and evidence strength for U.S. Department of Education practice guides.
- Lead author for USDA’s SNAP household characteristics report; managed data preparation and report production.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Purdue University 2025–present

- ECON 210: Principles of Economics** (Fall 2025; Prof. Benjamin Van Kammen). Lead weekly recitation sections; develop instructional slides; create and administer quizzes.
- ECON 451: Game Theory** (Fall 2025; Prof. Bettina Klose). Grade exams and problem sets; proctor exams; support coordination with undergraduate TAs.
- ECON 252: Macroeconomics** (Spring 2026; Prof. Andres Vargas). Teaching assistant.
- ECON 251 and ECON 252** (Spring 2026; Prof. Jacob Brindley). Developed exam questions remotely for Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics.
- ECON 252, ECON 515, and ECON 301** (Summer 2026; Prof. Andres Vargas). Provided teaching support across three economics courses.

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Michigan State University 2023–2024

- EC 301: Intermediate Microeconomics** (Spring 2024; Prof. Stacy Dickert-Conlin). Grade exams and problem sets; assist students with understanding in economics help room each week.
- EC 302: Intermediate Macroeconomics** (Fall 2023; Prof. Andrei Shevchenko). Grade exams and problem sets; assist students with understanding in economics help room each week.

AWARDS AND HONORS

Certificate for Outstanding Teaching, Purdue University	Fall 2025
–ECON 210: Principles of Economics	
Winner, Poster Presentation, 10th Annual KDSA Research Symposium, Purdue University	2025
–Poster: “Doing More with Less? Right-to-Work Laws, School Productivity, and Student Achievement”	
Paul A. Wright Scholarship, University of Michigan	2008–2010
Phi Beta Kappa, Augustana College	2005